



ETHICAL CODE OF CONDUCT

A Guide for Leadership

HOLDING SACRED OUR MISSION

*“To provide personal healing and transformation
through the use of our sacrament
in a safe and loving space held
in the spirit of our Yawanawá lineage.”*

SACRED CIRCLE OF THE LIGHT CHURCH, INC.



Welcome to the Sacred Circle of the Light Church. We welcome you with all the love in our hearts.

You have been called to Leadership, to stand in selfless service during these extraordinary times. We commend your courage and give thanks for your generous heart.

You are a Minister, Executive, Volunteer, a Team Member, Student, a Board Member, an Employee, or a Founding Member of our sacred community. **Let us also call you what we know you are – a Leader.** As such, you will be upheld in high regard. Your words will ring in the hearts of others, and you will be blessed with many rare and sacred experiences.

You will be privy to personal information, difficult transformations, challenges, duties, and doubts. You will have to hold confident all that is entrusted in you. Through this calling of Leadership not only will you witness the transformation of others, but you too will be transformed. You will experience the miraculous and face challenges. You will forge into the unknown and then give guidance to others. You will be blessed to share your gifts, support others, share tears and time with tribe. You will be praised as a saint, and sometimes misunderstood or criticized. Leadership is a rich experience and worth every second of your precious time. It's a blessing, a wonder, and a miracle.

As a Leader you are held to a higher standard than others. Your words will have more weight and your actions will closely be observed. All of what you do will be modeled by others and taken as correct. And so, to support you in this critical role of Leadership, we provide this guide.

This is our Ethical Code of Conduct. In it, we hope you find clarity and guidance. The Ethical Code of Conduct was developed by our entire Board and derived from our practical experience. Each individual Board Member gave valuable insights into the concepts and requirements it contains. This will be a 'living document' as we grow together. Our intention is to state our shared values, to offer grace for the inevitable missteps, but most importantly to provide safety for our community.

Please sign and return this document within two weeks of receipt. You must sign this before any service duty begins.

Welcome to the Leadership Circle of Sacred Circle of the Light Church. We love you, honor you and humbly thank you for your service.

Jim Whitney
Principal Minister / President

Sacred Circle of the Light Board of Directors

Jim Whitney, President	Trip Rickerson	Brittney van Zandt
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ETHICAL CODE OF CONDUCT

The Ethical Code of Conduct of the Sacred Circle of the Light Church is a document that governs the conduct of all those that are called to Leadership.

Any person in a position of Leadership in this Church agree to uphold this Ethical Code of Conduct and to be bound by its precepts. Leaders include the Principal Minister, Ordained Ministers, Executives, Volunteers, Active Members of the Fellowship, Team Members, Students, Board Members, Employees and Founding Members of our sacred community.

These precepts are specifically designed to articulate shared understandings and support our growing organization. This Code also protects Leadership within it, and most importantly, provides for the health, safety and welfare of our Community Members or Fellowship. Therefore, disciplinary measures may be taken in response to any violation of this Code in order to protect our sacred organization, our community, our members, and our leaders.

Definitions:

- *Leader:* Principal Minister, Ordained Minister, Executive, Volunteer (“Active Members”), Team Member, Student, Board Member, Employee and Founding Member of our sacred community and is bound by the guidelines of this document.
- *Principal Minister:* Founding minister and leader of the SCL church: Jim Whitney
- *Ordained Ministers:* Those ordained by the church to pour the sacrament. These have been properly trained according to a list of requirements set out by the Principal Minister and supervised before taking on their own full weekend.
- *Team Members:* Support team members sit at the front of the room, support participants, support the Principal Minister or Ordained Ministers, take on logistical tasks to make the experience run smoothly, comment in shares, and provide other healing elements.
- *Board Members:* Members of the Sacred Circle of the Light Board of Directors as prescribed by the SCL By Laws.
- *Executives:* The President, Treasurer and Secretary of the Board
- *Volunteers:* Any person who donates time and talent to the support of the organizations for no pay on a regular basis is an “Active Member” of our fellowship and therefore a Leader.
- *Employees:* Any person who receives compensation for their contribution to the Sacred Circle of the Light Church, Inc.

Title 1: Care of People

1.1 Our Leaders have a Duty and Authority to Care for the Health Safety and Welfare of the Members of our Community so that this Organization May Thrive

1.2 Basic Responsibility of Leaders

Claims and Representation: We value and require honesty from all. This includes honesty in your words and actions and also includes being pro-actively honest where it would be dishonest to leave something unspoken.



All Leaders must correctly represent their position here and the Mission of SCL “*To provide personal healing and transformation through the use of our sacrament in a safe and loving space held in the spirit of our Yawanawá lineage.*”

All Leaders must correctly represent themselves. To misrepresent who you are, your experience, or anything about yourself or the organization, is a violation of this Ethical Code of Conduct.

Misrepresentation: Representations that are unauthorized, false, or misleading are considered injurious and a misrepresentation of the Church.

If any misrepresentation or falsehood is discovered, Leaders must take responsibility and correct them, regardless of how, or by whom the misrepresentation is made.

Good Faith: When applying for a Leadership position, you must demonstrate a basic knowledge of the Values, Mission, Statement of Faith, and Agreements of the Church. All future Leaders must submit their information for a background check prior to being a Leader of the organization.

By Laws: The Principal Minister, President, Board Members, and Executives should demonstrate, knowledge of the SCL By Laws.

SCL Ethical Code of Conduct: All Leaders should demonstrate through their actions, knowledge of SCL Ethical Code of Conduct.

Peacemakers: Resolving any conflicts and using ethical decision making, as expressed by this Code, is highly honorable. All Leaders should strive to maintain peace throughout the Church.

Organization: All Leaders should strive to understand the scope and function of the founding chapter, Sacred Circle of the Light Church, and the boundaries that govern the behavior of the Leadership.

Respect: We respect each other. All Leaders should pay appropriate respect to the Executive Director/President/Principal Minister, Board Members, Ministers, Employees and other Team members and Volunteers and support their calling through their positive action and speech.

1.3 Church Mission

Path: All Leaders should have a basic understanding of the Church's Mission “*To provide personal healing and transformation through the use of our sacrament in a safe and loving space held in the spirit of our Yawanawá lineage.*”

If the Principal Minister agrees, a Leader who follows the education requirements have the opportunity on the path to become a Minister.

Ministers: A Minister is a person who has fulfilled the requirements to be ordained by the Sacred Circle of the Light and may lead Ceremony and pour the Sacrament. Requirements to become a



Minister are set by the Principal Minister and may or may not be amended to provide each individual with the appropriate amount of training.

Any Leader should understand that the first level of competence is to have a genuine, authentic calling to become a Leader, and to know the limits of your training (level of your competence) as you move forward.

1.4 Leadership Agreement

Leaders: Leaders are accepted into Team Member and Minister training only by the Principal Minister according to the training program and the Principal Minister supervision.

Team Members: Team Members agree to abide by the information contained in the following documents: *SCL Ethical Code of Conduct*, *Team Values and Agreements*, *Roles and Responsibilities* as well as be guided by any training materials, *The Chacruna Institute Ayahuasca Community Guide for the Awareness of Sexual Abuse* (see Addendum). They also agree to abide by verbal guidance from any Leader with more competence and training, team calls, trainings, and while in service. A Team Member can become eligible to become an Ordained Minister but not without the approval of the Principal Minister / President.

Authority: When in the training, Leaders become eligible for a position in the church. They cannot have a position in the church without training relevant to their position.

Duty: Every Team Member and Minister has a duty to seek guidance during their educational training from those with more experience, the Principal Minister and the *Ethical Code of Conduct* and other policies such as the *Values and Agreements*, and *Roles and Responsibilities*.

Education is a Duty: Once a Leader becomes a Team Member, they must manage their own education, ensure the organization is aware of their progress and continue training. Training refers to any and all verbal training, pre-team calls, observations made while in service, any reference materials and any direct training received by experienced members of the Team, Board, Ministers, or Principal Minister.

Serving Under Your Limits of Competence: A Minister is any SCL Team Member who, through the diligent fulfilling of their requirements, with the approval of the Executive Director / President / Principal Minister, has been called by Spirit to provide healing services, education, ceremonies, and so forth, for that which they have been appropriately trained and under direct supervision of the Principal Minister.

Both Ministers and Team Members must have a full understanding of his/her level of competency, and that good faith demonstration of their competency is required.

Good faith demonstration of competency is based on Church Education and Curriculum, transcripts, trainings, mentoring, experience which has been deemed equivalent, and so forth.



Lack of Competence: Whenever a Minister or SCL Team Member finds they are lacking in skill or competence in a given situation, he/she is careful to:

- Consult with the Principal Minister, Minister, or SCL Team Member,
- Defer the service until further education, training, or research may be obtained,
- Refer to competent Minister, SCL Team Member or other competent Professional.

Competence Representation: A Leader of the Church should never misrepresent themselves as a Team member or Minister. Likewise, an SCL Team Member or Minister should know that additional education and training is necessary to establish competence in any specific healing modality that falls outside of the training provided.

A team member should never offer to give massage, reiki, chiropractic services, psychotherapy, coaching services, integration assistance, psychiatric services, naturopathic counsel, “energy work” or any other healing modality as a general rule while in an any SCL Ceremony, retreat, or gathering. Under very rare circumstances there are exceptions. The exception is if the offering is:

- Approved by the Principal Minister, AND
- The Leader has been appropriately trained for the healing modality at a standard of competence and/or licensing requirements normally associated in society for that modality.

Anyone in a position of Leadership should never give false representation of their competence under any circumstances. Either in Ceremony, or in a social setting provided by SCL.

All representation of competence should be at least equal to the standards normally associated in society for that healing modality. Most importantly, Leadership and Team Members should never represent that they are competent to serve the SCL sacrament without being an Ordained Minister of the Sacred Circle of the Light Church.

Crisis or Emergency Services: In the event of a crisis or emergency, any Minister or SCL Team Members may assist, but only to the specific degree of their competence in the service rendered. The Domestic Good Samaritan Laws in every State are full of legal flaws.

Any Minister or Team Member that offers services for which they have not established competence places themselves, their families and all SCL in legal peril. **Under any and all emergency circumstances, Team Members and Ministers are required to call 911 for appropriate first response.**

If any participant threatens harm to any team member, participant, minister or themselves, Team Members and Ministers must notify the Principal Minister immediately and inform the participant they will not be able to return to the community.

Participant Commitment: All participants verbally agree to stay the weekend and sign a liability waiver prior to the retreat. In the event a participant wishes to leave prior to the end of a retreat weekend, they will be provided with a liability waiver to sign in person, and a one-page guide for integration.



If a participant fails to honor their commitment and intends to leave a retreat weekend, the Principal Minister and Team Members must work to ensure, to the best of their ability, that all the necessary steps are taken to provide safety to the organization, the group, and the participant who chooses to leave.

These steps are:

1. Principal Minister is notified immediately
2. Participant must sign waiver / exit form.
3. Ensure that they are safe to drive if driving
4. Ensure they understand the risks of leaving without the benefit of integration training.
5. Ensure they understand they will not be able to attend other ceremonies
6. Ensure they understand they will be removed from any future announcements

Maintaining Competence through Education and Training: Ministers and SCL Team Members understand that maintaining and continuing their education is mandatory. Failure to do so is a violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct.

However, no Minister or Team Member will be penalized for inability to pay for trainings. Sacred Circle of the Light will do everything it can to assist the Team Member or Minister with scholarships for training.

In addition, we recognize special limitations on travel and Dieta participation by women, and women with children. We strive to provide equivalent alternative training under these, and other special circumstances should they arise.

Personal Judgment: When making decisions, Leaders use their best personal judgment based on their experience, training, education, scientific inquiry, and so forth. They understand that they may be called upon to explain their decision-making process at any time by the Executive Director or other Ministers.

1.5 Interpersonal Relationships

Belief Systems: Any Leader shall not dictate the belief systems or healing modalities of any other person. We do not exclude participants, fellowship or other persons based on their personal spiritual beliefs. Even though a Leader may disagree, it is their responsibility to uphold and honor all belief systems and healing modalities that others may consider sacred.

Boundaries: All Leaders should respect the boundaries of others. It is considered dishonorable to disrespect the physical and verbal boundaries of others and a violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct. When working with others, participating in Ceremony, Healing Services, Councils, and so forth, reasonable respect for others and their boundaries shall be maintained.

Sacred Objects: As such we respect all sacred objects, tools, and instruments of other Leaders, Team Members and Ministers. We do not use these without being granted permission by the owner.



Free Will: All people must participate in Ceremony, Council, Healing Service, and so forth of their own free will and choice. It is the responsibility and duty of any SCL Team Member to uphold the individual's right to worship their Creator according to the dictates of their own heart.

Consent: Physical touch by anyone at any time, is only allowed after consent has been given verbally.

Criticism: All Leaders understand that when they criticize others, they are not following the Value of Conscious Communication. It is especially wrong, and a clear violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct, to criticize others because of their personal beliefs in a practice or Ceremony.

Guidance: It is acceptable to correct, guide, train, and remind fellow Leaders of the proper etiquette to be upheld in Ceremony, and we strive to not take anything personally in order to better facilitate the focus on participants and worship.

Solicitation: With the exception of the “Butterfly Marketplace” which provides a space for Fellowship to share offerings and services that SCL Church expressly does not endorse, or take any responsibility for the goods, services and events offered there, **it is a violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct, and dishonorable, for any Leader to attempt to solicit or persuade any member of the Fellowship into a different worship arena, sacrament offering, business, service or anything that may be deemed a conflict of interest with the Church and its mission.**

The Principal Minister, a Board Member and the Minister leading a Ceremony must be made aware of any attempts to solicit by Team Members or Leaders immediately.

To “solicit” means 1. To seek obtain by persuasion, entreaty, or formal application. 2. To petition persistently; importune. 2. To commit the criminal offense of enticing or inciting another to commit an illegal act. (As defined in The American Heritage ® Dictionary of the English Language, 5th Edition.)

It is a violation of this Ethical Code of Conduct for any Leader to fail to report such solicitation.

No Marketing of Products or Services to our Community: No solicitation or marketing materials will be tolerated in our list of members except where it is posted in the “Butterfly Marketplace” signal group.

Coercion: It is a violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct to use any form of pressure or coercion on individuals either to leave, or to remain in the SCL Community, a Ceremony, Board, Ministerial position, leadership role, and so forth. Service in all SCL endeavors is entirely voluntary.

Informed Consent: Where any SCL Team Member has been approved to provide support both in Ceremony or at any other SCL event, to any person, they must disclose completely the type of support, what to expect, if there is physical discomfort involved, what to do in preparation, possible outcomes, as well as possible risks or side effects. In order to consent, the participant must understand the forthcoming experience.



Before the establishment of any such support the person must give their consent based on being fully informed. Any support provided without informed consent are in violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct.

If for any reason a person is unable to give such informed consent, then consent must be obtained from a legal guardian or agent who is authorized to give such consent.

Simple Consent Form: Informed consent forms are often used as evidence in courts of law. Any informed consent forms ought to describe the consent of the person, not the content of the service, ceremony, sacrament, or sacred object.

Discrimination: Discrimination based upon religion, philosophical values, age, gender, race, ethnicity, socio-economic status, disability, sexual orientation, culture, language, and so forth is considered a violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct.

1.6 First Do No Harm

Harm: Harm means, for the purposes of this Ethical Code of Conduct, any injury to the physical, emotional, and spiritual body of an individual or the threat of such injury.

Application: Any course of Healing Service which, in itself, is injurious, or has inherent in its practice the potential to do such harm to the participants as to cause them to lose in any degree the capacity to function normally, is harmful and is to be avoided by all Leaders in all capacities in the SCL Church.

Decision Making: Using wisdom and being aware of the physical, emotional, and psychological safety of others is paramount for any SCL Leader. Services that may do harm must be avoided at all costs.

As a general principle, Leaders make decisions that will not result in harm based on a general risk vs reward rational basis. There is no official definition to this process, however the standard is that of a prudent person in a similar situation assessing both the risks and the rewards of the situation and circumstances on a rational basis.

If a desired benefit entails any degree of risk greater than those attendant with normal life activities, the SCL Team Member seeks other alternatives.

Standard of Conduct: We strive for a standard of not even the appearance of impropriety. For example, Team Members keep their hands visible at all times during treatment and never touch a participant with their hands under a participant's blanket or clothing. We do not strike any inappropriate pose or take a position which appears, or could appear in violation of the code.

Sexual or Emotional Harassment: Any demeaning or offensive physical advances, sexual solicitation, verbal or non-verbal sex or gender associated behavior, including flirtation, and so forth is not allowed by any Leader or any member of the Sacred Circle of the Light Church



Community. This behavior is also considered injurious and is a violation of this Ethical Code of Conduct.

Leadership in this arena, where members of our community and those that participate in our Ceremonies make themselves vulnerable emotionally and physically must be upheld by the highest ethical standards.

Leaders must be aware at all times, not only of their own behavior, but also of the appearance of their behavior by others. There must be not even the appearance of impropriety by those that wish to lead in Sacred Circle of the Light. This includes the use of profanity and the wearing of provocative attire.

Sexual Abuse: Inappropriate physical contact can be injurious, mentally, and physically. Any lack of permission is considered an act of sexual abuse and assault. This is not only a violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct, but also a violation of your Agreement of Doing No Harm. It is also illegal and a materially relevant liability of the Church.

All SCL Employees, Board Members, Executives, Team Members and Ministers are forbidden to engage in any practice that may result in inappropriate physical contact.

Inappropriate physical contact is any act leading to or associated with copulation.

There is no Healing Service allowed that may lead to inappropriate contact whether or not you have the express permission of all parties involved.

Pro-Active Reporting: Sexual abuse, harassment or any other illegal conduct must be reported to the Principal Minister or a Board member immediately. **A lack of reporting Sexual Abuse to the Principal Minister or a Board Member is a violation of this Ethical Code of Conduct.**

1.7 Confidentiality

Responsibility of Confidentiality: Leaders have a responsibility and obligation to maintain confidentiality in the best interest of the Church, its Fellowship members, fellow Leaders to whom they are providing support.

Confidentiality is a facet of that best interest. Keeping in confidence all personal information, stored documentation, records, discussions, and so forth is paramount. Failure to do so could be construed as Doing Harm to the individual participant receiving service.

No free or open-source internet services shall be used (i.e., google docs) only paid services with strict privacy controls will be used to ensure participant safety and medical confidentiality.

A separate confidentiality agreement will be signed by all Team Members and Ministers and Board Members that further outlines confidentiality obligations. These Leaders are subject to higher confidentiality standards and may on rare occasions need to exchange sensitive, personal, and



highly confidential information in order to support the Principal Minister, the organization, and other facets of administrative and Board duties.

Limitations on Confidentiality: SCL Team Members understand that extenuating circumstances, such as subpoena or other dictates of Law, sometimes place limitations on confidentiality.

When a SCL Team Member finds such limitations within the scope of the service to be provided, complete disclosure of such limitations to the person to receive the service is required.

When to break confidentiality: If anyone at any time whether participant, team member, board member, volunteer, or Minister threatens injury or harm to another, this must be reported to the President or a Board member immediately.

Electronic Transmission: Electronic Transmission often runs the risk of violating confidentiality. If electronic transmission is to be used, SCL Team Members are careful to fully inform the person receiving the service as part of the informed consent process.

Broken Confidentiality: If there is a legal or third-party reason that Confidentiality is to be broken, SCL Team Members are careful to inform the party receiving the service as part of the Informed Consent Process.

Recordings: Audio and or visual recording automatically brings the risk of violation of Confidentiality. Whenever SCL Team Members provide services that must be recorded, they inform the person prior to providing the service as part of the Informed Consent Process. A signed waiver of confidentiality will be required.

Confidentiality Breach: If for any reason Confidentiality is to be breached (Limitations on Confidentiality) informed consent to do so must be obtained from the person receiving the service. This informed consent should be in writing. If this is not possible, verbal informed consent is reasonable. Written documentation of verbal consent is always preferable.

Confidential Information: When consulting with colleagues, SCL Team Members are careful to keep confidential all information that might lead to the identification of a person when discussing the person outside of the participant weekend for training purposes.

Discussion between Team Members, Ministers, and Board Members for the purposes of operations, or violations of the Ethical Code of Conduct, or resolution of operational or personal issues, or participant or community fellowship safety concerns does not constitute a confidentiality breach.

1.8 Sacred Ceremonies

Suffering Relief: Every SCL Team Member makes a good faith effort to be actively and appropriately engaged in the relieving of suffering of all kinds. Relieving the suffering of the Individual, Family, Community, Society, and the Planet is paramount to the Church's Healing Ministry.



Transformation: SCL Team Members and Ministers share the Principal of Transformation as the core foundation of all Ceremonial activity. This core Principle is based in the belief that all Healing Services consist of facilitating the shift from illness to wellness be that physical, emotional, or spiritual.

Ceremony: SCL Team Members and Ministers understand the key importance of Sacred Ceremony in all SCL Healing Services. It is through our Religious Ceremonies that we are protected under the Law.

Every SCL Healing Service falls under the dictates of a Sacred Ceremony or other bona fide Ceremony. SCL Team Members and Ministers are dedicated to this religious belief, and they are always vigilant in attending to their duty in this regard.

Sacred Ceremony: Support of our SCL Sacred Ceremonies is among the most important duties and responsibilities of SCL Team Members and Ministers. Every SCL Team Member and Minister is the custodian of their spiritual role in a Ceremony. They harmonize their personal belief systems with their training grounded in the Yawanawa traditions as articulated in the Sacred Circle of the Light Statement of Faith. Any such icons, symbols, materials, modalities, and sacred objects they represent, become Sacraments used within the Sacred Circle of the Light Church.

1.9 Informed Consent

Information: Informed Consent for Healing Services is an absolute necessity. SCL Team Members / Ministers are careful to provide information concerning the service to be provided adequate to the kind and nature of the service to be provided and the level of competence of the person providing such service.

Consent: SCL Team Members / Ministers see to it, through the process of Informed Consent, that the person receiving Healing Services understands, within reason, the concept of Confidentiality, and also the limitations to Confidentiality, if any, that apply to the specific Healing Service.

Spiritual Orientation: SCL Team Member are careful to inform persons to whom they provide Healing Services that they have sought out the services of a Minister of Healing and that the services to be provided are of a Spiritual nature and are focused on Natural Healing.

They are extremely careful that every person for whom they provide services understands that they have requested the services of a Minister or Team Member of the Church, and that such services constitute for the SCL Team Member, as a Person under the Law, as an Ecclesiastic Body in General, and as a Church Entire, the very establishment and practice of their Religion.

1.10 Public Statements

Public Statements: SCL Team Members are careful to make only those public statements that pertain specifically to their own Sacred Circle of the Light beliefs. In general, that they have appropriately learned from the SCL By Laws, Statement of Faith, the SCL Ethics Code, the SCL



Training and Education, SCL Ceremonies, or from any Official SCL Publication or communication.

Only those Team Members and Ministers specifically authorized by the Executive Director / Minister to do so may speak or act for and on behalf of all Leaders, Team Members of SCL, or Church Entire, in any capacity or in any context.

Team Members and Ministers are required to be discreet and practice “attraction not promotion” as a guiding principle in communications.

1.11 Records and Confidentiality

Making Records: SCL Team Members and Ministers understand that, in the event of any Court Action, standard practice business-type records become property of the State and have often formed the very foundation of fallacious convictions against Healers.

Team Members are therefore very careful when they keep records to avoid using verbalisms common among Commerce Professions (professions by those who charge for services) and commit themselves to re-scripting so that all records harmonize with the true nature of a non-profit donation-based Healing Ministry. Ministers of the Church do not charge for their services, but a Donation may be suggested to support the Ministry.

Any Minister or Team Member charging fees for services while in direct service to the SCL Church, or while service in a Leadership role, classifies the service as commerce and therefore exempts the service from the legal protection and will be terminated from the Team or Ministry.

All Ministers, Team Members, Board Members donate their time to the SCL Church and mission. Any employee of the church maintains their competence inside the scope of the Church role for which they are hired.

1.12 Fees and Donations

No Fees Not Ever: SCL Team Member charge no fees for their Healing Ministry. Rather, the Church may make suggestions Minimum Donation or Minimum Offering amounts and gratefully receive such Offerings in return for the services rendered by the Church and its Team Members.

This is made clear in the Informed Consent Process and the SCL Team Member uses this term out of lack of a better alternative only. Any money, product, exchange, or so forth are considered as a donation by the Team Member, even when the person receiving the service may not.

1.13 Seminary Training

Seminary: A Seminary is a SCL Certified Institution. All SCL Team Member value education and should consider training from a SCL Certified Institution when available. All Team Member will refrain from offering services for which they are not adequately trained.



Seminary and Equivalency Standards: The standards for all Seminary Training will be set by the Executive Director and Minister of SCL with the approval of the Board. Changes, additions, amendments, and so forth, to the Standards will be regularly updated in the Official SCL records.

Training: When any training is received from Agencies and Institutions other than the Church or SCL Certified Seminaries, all transcript records and proof of completion must be sent to the Executive Director / President of the Church for approval and appropriate filing in the Individuals Physical File (IPF) of the SCL Team Members.

Training from such agencies or institutions (i.e., the Yawanawa tribe, or other programs in psychology, massage therapy, naturopathy) which reasonably meet the standards set by the Church or Executive Director / Minister as part of training, are deemed “essentially equivalent” to that provided by the Church or SCL Certified Seminaries. Training from such agencies or institutions which do not reasonably meet the standards set by the Church or Chief of Seminary Services are taken individually and may be deemed “equivalent in part.”

SCL Team Member take it upon themselves to be current in their knowledge of the Church and Seminary Standards and to constantly update their understanding of those Standards. Team Members must have a full understanding of his/her level of competency, and that good faith demonstration of their competency is required. Good faith demonstration of competency is based on Church Education and Curriculum, transcripts, trainings, mentoring, experience which has been deemed equivalent, and so forth.

Continuing Education: All SCL Team Members understand that continuing education is an absolute requirement and Agreement they have made and must be done on an annual basis.

Each SCL Team Member or Minister is careful to ensure they are utilized on the Team for at least one Ceremony weekend per year and / or obtain twenty hours of continuing education each year through service on the Team, Dieta, travel to the Yawanawa, direct training from the Executive Director / Minister. This continued education is pertinent to Religious Services or to the type and kind of Healing Services they provide.

When SCL Team Members and Ministers fail to obtain such continuing education, they understand that their status may be reduced or suspended altogether.

SCL Team Members and Ministers are careful to appropriately manage this aspect of their duty as a Minister of the Church and do not expect to be reminded to do so by their leadership.

Ministerial Training Requirements: In order to be ordained in the Sacred Circle of the Light Church, the following steps need to be taken to lead ceremony and pour the sacrament:

1. Attend either an Intensive or Dieta with Jim (and/or another Minister in a similarly situated Church approved by the Principal Minister that equates to the training he or she believes to be at the level and experience needed).
2. Participate in the making of our sacrament (or the equivalent. For example, you have actively attended a fetitio).



3. Receive a Seyá/Initiation from Matsini, Rasu or Dennis.
4. Spend at least 10-30 days with the Yawanawá in the Amazon rainforest.
5. Serve on the SCL ceremony team for 1-3 years (Community and/or Vets). This may include time spent serving sacrament in final stages under the strict supervision of the Principal Minister.
- OR -
6. Complete the one-year Muká Dieta (if we are to truly honor the path of the Yawanawá, this is their most sacred initiation and gives you the authority to pour Uni).

Title 2: Care of the Earth

2.1 Our Leaders Take Care of the Earth to Ensure a Sustainable Future

Future: SCL Team Members and Ministers consider themselves a part of the pattern and web of life. Natural Resources do not exist only to be consumed. SCL Team Members and Ministers understand that they are duty bound to work to provide a future for coming generations.

Natural Resources: SCL Team Members and Ministers are conscious of the affect the unchecked exploitation of natural resources has had on the Health of the Planet. This unnecessary exploitation has affected the state of wellness of all people physically, mentally, and spiritually. SCL Team Member dedicate themselves to finding and implementing ways to assist the individual, family, community, society, and the planet from arbitrary consumerism.

Sacraments: SCL Team Members should be careful to investigate the origin, ingredients, manufacturing, and so forth of their Sacraments and Sacred Objects they employ in their Healing Services. SCL Team Member should support manufacturers that do not merely take from the Earth, but rather, give back as much or more than they take.

People: SCL Team Members and Board Members and Ministers support each other to maintain a sustainable lifestyle in relationship with the SCL activities. We agree to uphold our human resources as a subject of value and strive to ensure that all leadership have a healthy and sustainable life balance.

Title 3: Sacred Sacraments

3.1 Safety is the Priority

Responsible Use: SCL Team Members and Ministers are personally responsible to have sufficient knowledge to avoid doing injury thereby. Responsible use is established when safety is the priority.

Guided Meditation, Journeying and Persuasion: Many forms of Natural Healing and Spiritual Enlightenment involve the use of guided meditation or “journeying” in safe environments. These Sacred Ceremonies can be performed with Sacred Sacraments, such as Uni, or without these Sacred Sacraments such as extended fasting, or breath work.



Any form of guided meditation, journeying, hypnosis, and so forth used by Team Members or Ministers are required to be trained in the benefits and risks of such Healing alternatives.

Any Team Member who uses such powerful tools to cause a person to do or say something they would not be inclined to do or say under normal circumstances is in frank violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct and it is considered very dishonorable.

This control is most especially observed in “regression strategies,” where the appearance and subsistence of “False Memory Syndrome” has been positively linked to the practitioner’s suggestions. SCL Ministers and Team Members are careful to use no suggestion or persuasion that could cause harm.

In addition, any therapeutic counsel or advise given by Team Members or Ministers before, during or after any form of Ceremony must be done so with the utmost caution as the power of persuasion is often increased during these modalities.

Title 4: Care of Society

4.1 Our Leaders Care for our Society and Our Community System:

The Sacred Circle of the Light Church Non-Profit “By Laws” document outlines a system of governance for the Church. SCL Leaders understand this system and use it to work to heal society in their Chapter, District, SCL Community within the SCL Programs.

Duty to Care for Society: SCL Ministers and Team Members understand that they should not be authorized or expected to do all jobs but rather to play to their skills and strengths. All Leaders operates in service to our shared mission. To serve the mission, Leaders rely on collective wisdom and shared responsibility.

No Press or Public Marketing: Leaders know that it is a part of their duty to ensure the integrity of the Sacred Circle of the Light Church and abide by an “attraction not promotion” ethos.

Resource Mindfulness: It is a Leader’s duty to assist SCL Church in growing and healing the world organically and with mindful awareness of the energy and resources that the Church consumes on all levels.

Serving the Mission: All efforts by all Leaders are for the end purpose of serving the Sacred Circle of the Light Mission.

- Board Members can fulfill their duty by faithfully ensuring the mission is served by setting short- and long-term goals, supporting the mission and remaining steadfast to their legal fiduciary obligations for greater and greater fiscal health and to steer the organization away from legal liabilities.
- Team Members and Ministers can fulfill their duty by faithfully participating in Ceremonies, Community Gatherings, Sacrament making, training with the Yawanawa, volunteering efforts for Ceremony Weekends and so forth. Every SCL Team Member and



Minister shares a responsibility to sustain and assist the Board of Directors and Executive Director / Minister / President in good faith.

- Volunteers can fulfill their duty by faithfully participating in the activities that support Sacred Circle of the Light activities such as set up and break down of ceremonies, organizing social events, providing donated professional services, and through financial donations.
- Employees can fulfill their duty by faithfully participating in the work that support a thriving organization.

SCL Organization: The SCL By-Laws and organizational chart outlines the leadership of the Church. No SCL Team Member or group of SCL Team Members may purposefully circumvent the SCL By Laws or the SCL Code of Ethical Conduct. To do so is dishonorable.

Authority: The SCL Church Non-Profit By Laws establishes the Authority within the Church. It is through the Board Members, Executive Director / President and Committees, and the President of the Church that the Authority is given to authorize the carrying out of the Stewardship and activities of the Church.

- No Team Member, Minister, Volunteer, or Employee may bypass the line of authority.
- No Leader may dictate the activities of the Church without proper authority as stated in the By Laws.
- All Leaders only have authority over their individual Role.

Board of Directors: The Board of Directors and the Executive Director / President is the Authoritative Voice of the SCL By Laws. The Board is the only body within the SCL authorized to ratify, change, or amend the By Laws.

As such, legally the Board of Directors is the only Council or Authority within the SCL that may have oversight over, or administration of matters pertaining to all the SCL members everywhere. No other agency or authority may speak or act for or on behalf of SCL.

Board of Directors Committees: The SCL By Laws authorizes Board Members to lead SCL Committees.

- The Board of Directors may appoint Leaders of Committees to fill administrative positions and to carry out the policies, procedures and to fulfill the objectives set by it, but such Leaders rely upon the Board of Directors for authority and direction.
- They may act autonomously within their Stewardships, but they understand that their actions fall under the oversight of the Board of Directors, and that they may be countermanded (revoked or canceled) in any decision, and/or replaced by that Board.



Title 5: Care for Peace and Safety

Leaders in the Sacred Circle of the Light stand by the Ethical Code of Conduct. All Leaders understand an obligation to comprehend, uphold and work to maintain the concepts herein with vigilance. This section outlines the processes and procedures available for the resolution of conflicts, how to determine if a violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct has occurred, and what is the required outcome once that determination is made.

5.1 The Resolution of Conflicts and Enforcement of the Ethical Code of Conduct

Power to Enforce: The Board of Directors has given the authority for Board Members to act in a disciplinary capacity as vested in the Disciplinary Councils where an actual or perceived violation, injury, threatened injury, and so forth has taken place.

Establishment of Disciplinary Council: A Disciplinary Council will determine if an actual violation has taken place and is required to provide a resolution in the form of a *Council Resolution*. If a violation is found, the Disciplinary Council is required to provide a *Plan of Restitution* to be approved by the Board of Directors and President / Principal Minister.

- A Disciplinary Council is a special caucus of the organization where the offense took place.
- Board Members of the Church Chapter convene in a Disciplinary Council.
- In the case of other Church Chapters, or where no Chapter exists, the President/Principal Minister of the SCL Church may call upon existing Chapters to fill the Board who will then establish the Disciplinary Council.
- In the case where the suspected violation may involve Chapter Board Members, or the President, Leaders of the Church will work to establish a Disciplinary Council of Board members who are not involved in the controversy.
- All decisions of the Disciplinary Councils are final.

Civil Domestic Law and Conflicts of Ethics: If a person in a Leadership position ever experiences a conflict between civil domestic law (i.e., harm to property, personal injury, fraud) and the Ethical Code of Conduct he/she must contact the Executive Director / President / Principal Minister or a Board member of the Church immediately.

Criminal Law: If a Leader is charged with violation of a criminal law, they must report this to the Principal Minister or a Board Member immediately. A Council Resolution is required for the member to maintain a leadership role in the community.

5.2 How to Resolve Violations of the Ethical Code of Conduct

All steps to resolve violations are confidential and remain private matters. Any person brought into any step of the resolution process should adhere to strict confidentiality. SCL Principal Minister and Board commit to the swift and fair resolution of any violation of the Code of Conduct and resolve that any violation or conflict will be resolved within 60 days.



Steps to Resolve Violations: There are two types of violations, those where there is a threat of physical injury or harm to others, and those where there is no threat of injury. Most importantly, for the health, safety, and welfare of the community:

- All Leaders (including volunteers and employees) must actively report any threat of physical injury or activity that puts any other person in the community in harm's way, or causes injury, immediately to the Principal Minister / President of SCL.
- Any behavior that causes harm/injury requires a Formal Inquiry process. These must be a Formal Resolution and determination of no wrongdoing for the Leader to remain in their Leadership position.

Informal Resolution Process: For Ethical Code of Conduct violations that are not immediately, physically harmful, the first step is an Informal Resolution process.

Informal Resolution: If a Leader believes that another Leader has acted in violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct, and there is no threat of personal injury or harm, the first step is an Informal Resolution:

- First, take a kind, considerate approach. Give the Leader the benefit of the doubt, and set aside time for a private consultation with the suspected offender wherein you may maintain a sense of curiosity, understand what happened, and only then discuss the suspected violation and provide constructive alternatives.
- A friendly and peaceful resolution of any perceived Ethical Code of Conduct violation is always preferred to a Formal Inquiry.

Formal Inquiry: If an Informal Resolution is unsuccessful to amend the behavior, then Formal Inquiry is the next step. Bring the suspected violation to the attention of the Principal Minister, who will then notify the Board of Directors.

All Formal Inquiries are known as Disciplinary Councils. They shall include full knowledge and disclosure to the accused that an inquiry is taking place. The accused will be afforded foreknowledge of the Council meeting and be informed of the violation, and will be allowed to present Personal Witness.

Determine the Method Arbitration or Council: Depending on the scope of injury, the ethical violation and the parties involved, the Principal Minister/ President may at his or her discretion attempt to enact:

- Arbitration Resolution with the Principal Minister as Arbitrator OR a
- Council Resolution with a majority of members of the Board of Directors effecting a Disciplinary Council.

Required Result: Each method whether Arbitration or Council Resolution must result in a written Resolution (the determination including what part of the Code was violated and how) and a Restitution Plan (what will be done as a result) and provided to the accused Leader that outlines the decided determination and remedy for the Ethical Code of Conduct violation.



When to use a Formal Inquiry /Disciplinary Council: Use a Formal Inquiry when there is:

- A threat of injury
- An actual injury
- A suspected violation not remedied by Informal Inquiry
- A suspected violation pertaining to more than one individual
- Violation is pertaining to the SCL in General
- If the suspected violation pertains to a particular Minister, Executive Minister, Church Executive, Employee, Volunteer, Board Member, Team Member, Chapter, District, or Department, the President and/or Principal Minister will hear the matter in a Formal Inquiry.
- In the case of a matter relating to the President or Principal Minister a Board member may implement a Formal Inquiry with a majority of other Board members present.

Arbitration Resolution: If all the Parties involved in the ethical violation agree to arbitration, the Principal Minister / President of the Church will either act as single Arbitrator or shall appoint one from the Board of Directors that both parties agree to.

- Decision of the Arbitrator is final.
- All Leaders will respect and honor the Arbitrator's decision.

Council Resolution: If all the Parties do not agree to arbitration, the President of the Church will call for an appropriate Disciplinary Council made up of a majority of Board members to hear the matter that all parties agree to.

- A Council Resolution is the decision of the Disciplinary Council. It is a required document filed in the Church records that signals the completion of a Formal Inquiry. It must state the activities that lead to the accusation of a violation of the Ethical Code of Conduct, and if a violation was found, it must also clearly identify the section of the Code that describes the violation.
- Decision of the Council is final. All Leaders will respect and honor the Council's decisions.

Plan of Restitution: A Plan of Restitution is also required if a violation is found. All Leaders will respect and honor the Plan of Restitution as set for by the Arbitrator or Disciplinary Council. It may include restoration of something lost or stolen to its proper owner, recompense for injury or loss, or the restoration of something to its original state.

Confidentiality: Resolving Ethical Code of Conduct violations will require a careful examination of all evidence from both the accused and the injured parties. Leaders know that the confidentiality of these conflicts is paramount, and care is taken to assure confidentiality. A Non-Disclosure Agreement will be signed by all parties prior to the Disciplinary Council or Arbitration. Unless written consent is obtained from all parties to release the findings of the conflict, confidentiality will be maintained by all parties involved in the conflict and resolution.

Truth: If called to answer to participate in an Arbitration or Disciplinary Council, a Leader is obligated to be truthful and to willingly participate. Only truthful reporting of all they understand



concerning the matter shall be permitted. Failure to participate, be truthful, or avoid Arbitration or Disciplinary Council is itself a violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct, and is dishonorable.

Personal Witness: Leaders may only give personal witness for Arbitration or Disciplinary Council. Leaders may only speak only for themselves, what they personally know, or about any evidence that came into their personal possession. They may not speak for others, provide opinion, or intuition. Personal witness is used only to bring forth factual information.

Personal Agency: Leaders shall not represent another Team Member. They may only be a proxy to read a personal account of another and may not speak for anyone else.

Scope of Decision: Disciplinary Councils are empowered to decide for or against the violation as it has been reported and proven, and to either recommend the expulsion of the Leader from their role and/or their standing in the Fellowship of the community to the President of the Church, or they may recommend a Restitution Plan to give the offending Leader an opportunity to make amends and to restore their good standing.

- **Restitution Plan:** Disciplinary Councils and Arbitrators must offer a Plan of Restitution to the Offender convicted of violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct, except where the violation results in injury to a person or persons for which restoration cannot reasonably be expected. The two guiding Principles upon which all Plans of Restitution are based must be first, severity, so that a repeat violation is avoided, and second, restoration, insofar as reasonably possible, of the state of affairs which existed before the violation. The question is, will the Plan of Restitution be severe enough so that the violation does not occur again? And will it be able to restore the relationships, circumstances, and environment to one of the peace that existed before the violation or conflict? The required elements of a Plan of Restitution are as follows:
 - The Restitution Plan must be approved by a majority of the Board of Directors.
 - The Offender must demonstrate a state of true repentance and a willingness to comply with the Restitution Plan.
 - The Restitution Plan must be designed in such a way as to reasonably assure the likelihood of success.
 - All Restitution Plans must include not less than six (6) months, but never more than two (2) years, probation, in which the Offender is not allowed to participate in any Council Service, or hold any leadership position.
 - During such probation the Offender must forfeit their SCL Minister Ordination and Leader Status to the Principal Minister / President of the Church.
 - Once evidence of the correction of the violation has been established, the Minister Ordination and Team Member Status will be returned after the probationary period.
- **Expulsion:**
 - Disciplinary Councils are authorized to recommend the expulsion only of any Offender when there is an injury upon a person or persons that has actually taken place, and for which restoration cannot be reasonably expected, or,
 - When an Offender refuses to comply with a Restitution Plan.
 - A Leader may be expelled from the SCL Church only upon a Recommendation by a Disciplinary Council, and,



- Upon receiving such a recommendation, the President of the Church will present the recommendation to the Board for a majority of the SCL Board's approval.

Participation Obligatory: SCL Leaders understand that they are duty bound to respond to and participate with the Disciplinary Councils, and that the decision of such Councils is final. Failure to attend or comply with a Disciplinary Council along with the Restitution Plan established by said council is a violation of the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct, and is in itself a basis for expulsion from the Church.

5.3 The Resolution of Conflicts with Other Organizations and Church Chapters

Resolving Community Conflicts: SCL Leaders strive to work to establish connections between their Chapter, District, Church, the Yawanawa tribe and others around the world. While the world is filled with differing cultures and standards, Leaders make a commitment not to involve the SCL organization with any group, tribe, organization, church, or sect that does not reasonably align with SCL Ethical Code of Conduct.

If internal conflict arises that is not in conflict with the Ethical Code of Conduct, within any organization of the Church, or any other Chapter, it is the President / Principal Minister's responsibility to resolve said conflict.

If the President of the Church is unable to guide the matter to an appropriate resolution, then the President will call for an emergency meeting of the Board of Directors to hear the matter. The majority decision of the Board of Directors is final.

5.4 Amendment to the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct

Amendments: The SCL Ethical Code of Conduct is subject to changes and improvements so as to accommodate a growing non-profit religious organization. Changes, additions, deletions, and amendment of any kind to the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct falls to the Board of Directors and Ethics Committee on an annual review basis.

All SCL Leaders agree to uphold this Code and to be bound by its precepts.

I, _____, on this day _____ have read and understand the SCL Ethical Code of Conduct. I agree to abide by this Ethical Code of Conduct to the best of my ability.

Any violation of this Code of Conduct, whether intentional or unintentional is subject to review and reprimand by the Board of Directors of Sacred Circle of the Light and may result in removal from my role as a Leader whether a Team Member, Board Director, Ordained Minister, Principal Minister, Volunteer or Community Member.



ADDENDUM

The following addendum is for reference and contains additional agreement and documents for Team Members and Leadership of the SCL community.

Team Values and Agreements

TRUST - We are being Divinely guided.

- We share a deep trust in the sacred sacrament.
- We share a deep trust we are all doing our best and we are here to grow.

SERVICE - We are here for a higher purpose.

- Understanding we are working together as a team toward the higher, common purpose of serving the sacrament and our participants in ceremony.
- Heart-centered, humble service
 - ◇ to the divine
 - ◇ to each other
 - ◇ to our participants
 - ◇ to the community

TEAMWORK - We're all in this together.

- We aspire for coherence among our team which creates a higher level of safety for our ceremony participants.
- We acknowledge and respect one another's roles and contributions in service.
- We agree to support each other in a collaborative effort toward our shared higher purpose.
- We agree to work in harmony with one another in the spirit of co-creation, spiritual growth & transformation.

SELF-RESPONSIBILITY - We each own our part in all our affairs.

- Holding ourselves accountable to our agreements and commitments
(This includes acknowledging broken agreements and making amends)
- Taking responsibility for the energy we each bring into the shared space.
(Note: defensiveness, blame and excuses are the antithesis to self-responsibility)

CONSCIOUS COMMUNICATION - We commit to authentic relating and connection.

- Processing our own stuff before bringing it to an individual or to the group
- Using "I" statements
- Taking responsibility for our own feelings
- Practicing active listening so others can feel seen, heard, valued.
- Having the intention to communicate from our hearts with kindness, love, respect, compassion, and curiosity.
- Having the intention to be a safe space for others to express their truth and share ideas.



- Holding confidentiality amongst the team and within the ceremonies

THE FOUR AGREEMENTS (As a practice)

By Don Miguel Ruiz

1. BE IMPECCABLE WITH YOUR WORD

- Speak with integrity.
- Follow through with what you say you are going to do.
- Say only what you mean.
- Avoid gossip about others.
- Use the power your word in the direction of truth and love.
- Speak to one another with love, respect, compassion, openness, curiosity, and kindness.

2. DON'T TAKE ANYTHING PERSONALLY

- Nothing others do is because of you.
- What others say and do is a projection of their own reality, their own dream.
- When you are immune to the opinions and actions of others, you won't be the victim of needless suffering.

3. DON'T MAKE ASSUMPTIONS

- Find the courage to ask questions and express what you really want.
- Communicate with others as clearly as you can to avoid misunderstandings, sadness, and drama. With just the one agreement, you can completely transform your life.

4. ALWAYS DO YOUR BEST

- Your best is going to change from moment to moment; Under any circumstances, simply do your best, and you will avoid self-judgment and regret.



TEAM ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

SIGN-UP SHEET

Updated: July 12, 2023

Number of participants: _____

Number on Team: _____

To the best of our abilities, we practice Don Miguel Ruiz' **FOUR AGREEMENTS:**

1. **Don't take anything personally:** Nothing others do is because of you. What others say and do is a projection of their own reality. When you are immune to the opinions and actions of others, you won't be the victim of needless suffering.
2. **Be impeccable with your word:** Speak with integrity. Say only what you mean. Avoid using the word to speak against yourself or to gossip about others. Use the power of your word in the direction of truth and love. Say what you mean, but don't say it mean.
3. **Always do your best:** Your best is going to change from moment to moment; it will be different when you are healthy as opposed to sick. Under any circumstances, simply do your best, and you will avoid self-judgement, self-abuse, and regret.
4. **Don't make any assumptions:** Find the courage to ask questions and to express what you really want. Communicate with others as clearly as you can to avoid misunderstandings, sadness, and drama.

1st TEAM MEETING IS AT 3:30PM FRIDAY

CEREMONY BEGINS AT 4PM

RULES OF PLAY: It's true we do have some rules.

- Final team debriefs are via Zoom Wednesday or Thursday post ceremony. Please make suggestions needed in the team meeting, NOT during the weekend.
- Walk slow, talk slow, stay relaxed and have fun.
- For the safety and benefit of the participants, we try to keep Jim and Ally's sole focus on any emergencies, ceremony, participants, and spiritual elements of the weekend.
- Always look to Jim for confirmation before assisting a participant in a healing, or if they are in a deep process. Do not sit in Jim's seat unless asked.
- At least 1 team member seated on the Dias at all times in addition to Jim's seat.
- Jim is always open to your suggestions to create a more healing space during ceremony, however, please check your personal motivations.
- Stay in your own Role / Lane. We have a Point Person for our weekends! A single point of contact related to all logistics for team and participants. So, in an effort to minimize talking about operations during the weekend, and maintaining noble silence, we kindly ask you to do only your own job. The Point Person will keep track of the overall logistics and manage jobs throughout the weekend.
- But certainly, ask for assistance of team members if needed in the moment.
- Each person is responsible for any announcements related to their job.
- Please maintain noble silence with participants and each other during ceremony.
- Check in with Jim if you are tired, and take time outs and rest when needed.
- Principles above personalities. *Please* address any misunderstanding or personality conflicts with fellow team members right away. Use a private space away from



participants. And please understand that the sacrament makes you more emotionally sensitive.

- If the issue can't be sorted, please agree on a trusted third person on the team, who will make the decision for you.
- During the weekend - Direct logistical issues with the point person

ROLES: Please understand your role completely and look through the weekend's duties prior to choosing your role

Point Person / Training Lead (one contact for all logistics and Qs) Point person is responsible for ALL SET UP PRIOR TO 3:30 Team Meeting as well as completion of all jobs and ad-hoc issue troubleshooting throughout weekend _____

Ceremony Space (1) _____

Fire Tender / Candles inside and outside (1): _____

Food Duty (1): _____

Food Delivery Only (1): _____

Kitchen Clean-Up (2): _____

Bathrooms (1): _____

Buckets (1): _____

Welcome Party (1): _____

Serving Cup Cleaner (always by hand thnx!) (1): _____

Fellowship Shepherd (1): _____

Notes:

If you see a change needed on this sheet, please address it at the follow up team meeting!

FRIDAY SET UP

ALL HANDS ON DECK before our team meeting at 3:30PM

Point Person:

- Ensure all duties are complete prior to 3:30PM Team meeting.
- Write schedule on Board and post for participants at kitchen each day.

Welcome Party :

- Get list of participants from Jim
- Turn on heat or AC in sleeping spaces.
- Ensure there are enough beds for all participants and team members.

Food Duty:

- Food Delivery – check that food is organized and in refrigerator,
- Check participant dietary restrictions.
- Set out Friday snack foods.

Ceremony Space:

- Ensure the ceremony space is comfortable and clean for the entire weekend.
- Control temperature and lights in the space at all times.



- Ensure water is set up and full throughout the weekend.
- Place rugs at team area first – so that Jim can set up sound system and altar.

Bathroom / Hand washing and Shower Areas:

- Buckets in latrines
- Periodic checking for cleanliness
- Place hand soap at all hand washing stations including behind the kitchen.
- Fresh hand towels (in a bin in trailer)
- Candles in bathrooms
- Saw dust / cedar shavings under stairs at latrines – please make announcement that there should be 1 scoop for #2 only.
- Lighters and incense in each prior to evening

Fire Tender / Candles:

- Prepare firewood and fire pits / split wood for evening ceremony if needed.
- Check batteries in LED candles, ensure rechargeable batteries are in their station and recharging.
- Candles – in ceremony space and set out all candles light way to purge area,

Welcome Party 1PM-3PM:

- Welcome Participants to property, help them to find a bed, ceremony space.
- Indicate parking limitations.
- Let them know ceremony starts at 4:00PM
- Review location of bathrooms and showers
- Parking for participants is off the street only.
- Point out where to get water /ice if they need it.

Kitchen Duty:

- Make Flower bouquets (all bathrooms, dining table and ceremony)
- Cut apples.
- Set out Friday snacks.

Kitchen Clean-Up:

- Clear snack, return dry food to garage.
- Empty garbage and recycling from kitchen for clean start to the weekend
- Ensure outdoor cans have the garbage and recycle pressed down for weekend and have room (they are in the carport at O'Shea's house)
- Label bins so participants note (recycle / trash)
- Separate combustibles to help reduce the recycle pick up at the house.
- Fill hot water percolator with filtered water / leave tea bags out for tea.
- Ensure 5-gallon water container is loaded on dispenser.

Fellowship Shepherd:

- Bell at 3:45PM to draw the fellowship in for the first ceremony.
- Alert the team for meeting at 3:20 for 3:30 meeting.
- Make sure everyone gets to the space on time.
- Time shares (2 min for team, 4 minutes for fellowship)



Ceremony / Night

Point Person:

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Ensure all duties are complete.
- Manage any logistics questions.

Food Duty:

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Prepare food, potatoes and fruit, no utensils, small plates.

Ceremony Space

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Ensure water dispenser is full.
- Make hot water and put peppermint tea in place in ceremony space.

Food Carrier:

- Small paper plates, napkins, serving utensils to ceremony space.
- Clear tables for buffet in ceremony space
- When food is ready, take in.

Food Clean-Up:

- Clear food from ceremony room, put away leftovers in fridge (containers will be left out from food prep)
- Wash dishes
- Take out trash if needed.

Fire Tender / Candles:

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Ensure candles are turned off, extinguished at the end of the night.

Serving Cups:

- After each serving, wash ceremony cups.
- Bring Jim a fresh damp paper towel to wipe bottle.
- do NOT put these in a dishwasher, they will break.

Buckets

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Fill buckets with water and dish soap to soak overnight.
- Wash first thing in the morning.

Bathrooms

- Make announcements during share (see last page)
- Please check that fans remain on
- Check that incense and lighters remain in bathrooms, light if necessary.



SATURDAY

Morning

Point Person:

- Write schedule on board and put up on kitchen counter for participants to see at breakfast.
- Ensure all duties are complete for the morning.
- Manage any logistics questions.

Ceremony Space:

- Ensure water dispenser is full.
- Ensure hot water is full, tea available.
- Clean-up for film screening, fold all blankets, tissues to garbage, remove dirty buckets if any, replace any Kleenex boxes, return the space to a welcoming state.
- Buckets go behind the kitchen at the back sink near the kitchen shower.
- Fill hot water percolator.
- Make sure water container is filled at all times in ceremony space.

Food Duty:

- Prepare Breakfast according to time decided night before.
- Water container with fresh water for the morning from sink (it is filtered rainwater)

Fellowship Shepherd:

- Cowbell at breakfast
- Shepherd for yoga / movie / hape / ceremony all day
- Time all activities keep them on track, notify leaders when activity is over.

Clean-Up :

- Put all breakfast items away, into dry storage kitchen bin.
- Put remaining food in fridge.

Bathrooms:

- Change hand towels
- Clean toilettes if needed.
- Turn on fans if needed.
- Make sure fan on side switch for whole system is on at max capacity.
- Make sure lids are down.

Kitchen Clean-Up: Clean any dishes, utensils, platters place all items on the kitchen cart.

- Return unused food to refrigerator, dry goods go *inside* sealed bins in kitchen.

Buckets

- Wash / turn over to dry.

Afternoon

Point Person:



- Write schedule on board and put up on kitchen counter for participants to see at breakfast.
- Ensure all duties are complete for the morning.
- Manage any logistics questions.

Food Duty:

- Afternoon snack
- Cut apples.

Fellowship Shepherd:

- Ring the bell for sharing circle and ceremony -
- Give participants 10-15 minutes warning, knock on doors of team.
- Ensure that everyone gets to the space on time, including the team!
- Time shares (2 min for team, 4 minutes for fellowship)

Kitchen Clean-Up:

- Check garbage and recycling, empty if needed.
- Fill hot water percolator with filtered water.
- Fill silver water container with water

Fire Tender:

- Ensure there is enough wood for the evening.

Night:

Ceremony Space

- Make hot water for the evening / put out tea.
- Ensure water dispenser is full at all times.

Food Duty:

- Prepare post-ceremony Food.

Food Carrier:

- Small paper plates, napkins, serving utensils out on counter.
- Set up buffet table.
- When food is ready, take to ceremony space.

Kitchen Clean-Up

- Wash dishes and put away all dishes and utensils.
- Clear all food, platters, utensils from ceremony space.
- Wipe counter tops
- Empty garbage and recycling if needed.
- Ensure drinking water container is full.

Fire Tender / Candles:

- Ensure candles are turned off, extinguished at the end of the night.

Serving Cups:



- After each serving, wash ceremony cups.
- Bring fresh damp paper towel to wipe bottle.

Buckets:

- Fill with water and eco-soap to soak overnight.

SUNDAY

Morning

Food Duty:

- Preparing Breakfast according to sheet and time decided night before.
- Cut apples prior to ceremony, deliver to Jim.

Fellowship Shepherd:

- for breakfast
- for sharing
- for Ceremony
- For supper / integration talk if needed
- All breaks

Ceremony Space:

- Hot water filled, tea out.
- Set up canvas tarp across from fire pit blankets, outdoor pads.
- Announce: no fuzzy blankets outside, Mexican blankets only

Bathrooms:

- Change hand towels
- Check toilets – clean if needed.
- Fans on!
- Lighters and incense light if needed.

Kitchen Clean-Up:

- Clean any dishes, utensils, platters from breakfast.
- Return unused food to refrigerator, dry goods go inside sealed bins.
- Check garbage recycling, empty if needed.

Buckets:

- Behind Kitchen at sink - wash and turn over to dry

Afternoon

Food Duty: prep

- Preheat over 1.5 hours before food needed (Jim will give you a 1.5-hour warning)
- Prepare Celebration Dinner Food



- Have hot food ready to go on warm: times change, make it so that you can serve it within 10-15 minutes.
- Jim will give the 10-15 minutes request for the food.

Fellowship Shepherd:

- Signal for dinner
- Signal if needed for sharing/breaks.
- Time shares (2 min team, 4 minutes fellowship)

Food Carrier:

- Large, small paper plates, paper bowls, napkins, serving utensils, 2 tongs, 2 ladles, out on counter.
- When food is ready, take to ceremony space – set on buffet tables in ceremony room.

Kitchen Clean-Up:

- Help to guide participants in clean-up of kitchen.
- Take out garbage.
- Bring all food, utensils, and garbage back to kitchen area.
- Clear all food, platters, utensils from ceremony space.

Ceremony Space Clean-Up – All participants help out.

- Help to orchestrate and guide participants.
- Load trailer - back jacks, rugs, bins, all ceremony space contents the way they were found.

Fire Tender / Candles:

- Ensure candles are turned off, extinguished at the end of the night.

Buckets:

- Behind the kitchen area – at sink
- Complete wash and turn over to dry for
- Stack and storage in the morning

MONDAY

Morning:

Buckets:

- Ensure that buckets are clean and stacked for storage.

Kitchen Duty:

- Put out leftover breakfast foods,
- hard boiled eggs, fruit, yogurt, granola, bread for participants
- Distribute food leftovers to team / volunteers.
- Final clean up and packing



Kitchen Clean Up:

- Put out leftover breakfast foods,
- hard boiled eggs, fruit, yogurt, granola, bread for participants
- Distribute food leftovers to team / volunteers.
- Final clean up and packing of SCOTL things in bins.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

Leadership:

- *Sacred line between team and participants*
- *Healing mat protocols*
- *Noble Silence*
- *Team will come to you.*

Point Person:

- *Schedule will be posted each day,*
- *room assignments are posted,*
- *In case of emergency please find a team member*
- *Everything that is yours is to your RIGHT.*
- *Please help us by keeping your space neat –i.e., keeping track of and folding your blankets*
- *Please remove blankets, pillowcases, hang towels on the hooks before leaving*

Food Duty:

- *No food in the cabins or sleeping areas.*

Ceremony Space:

- *Point out where water is available.*
- *No fuzzy blankets outside,*
- *Shoes outside the door to the side*
- *No phones in the space during ceremony*

Bathroom / Hand washing and Shower Areas:

- *Absolutely no showers during ceremony*
- *Lotus Ranch: Please observe the ladies and gents' bathrooms in main sleeping hall,*
- *Lotus Ranch: ceremony bathrooms gender neutral*
- *Oshea's: obey scoop law #2 requires scoop.*

Buckets:

- *No tissue in buckets, put beside your seat.*

Fire Tender / Candles:

- *No fire tending by participants in the sacrament during ceremony.*
- *Don't throw anything in the fire, keep it clean.*



Fellowship Shepherd:

- *Please state the importance of being on time to ensure humane experience for our guests and team(lateness in the day carries into the night = less sleep for the team)*
- *I will bang a ____ at ____ minutes before the next event.*

Property

- *Boundary limits of the property*
- *No hot tub or cold plunges during ceremony*
- *Please wear your shoes when outside*
- *Please know that we will check on you if you go outside.*

THE CHACRUNA INSTITUTE AYAHUASCA COMMUNITY GUIDE FOR THE AWARENESS OF SEXUAL ABUSE

Abuse is never your fault. If anything happens, speak up, reach out!

Sexual abuse and misconduct towards female participants in ayahuasca circles are, unfortunately, quite prevalent. Exact numbers are difficult to obtain, as most cases never come to light; nonetheless, the issue is common knowledge within the ayahuasca community. As an organization dedicated to providing public education and cultural understanding about plant medicines, we at the Chacruna Institute for Psychedelic Plant Medicines do not wish to dissuade women from drinking ayahuasca, but rather to raise awareness about sexual harassment, and offer practical guidelines in the interest of keeping female participants in ayahuasca ceremonies and communities safe. While our guide is aimed toward preventing female participant abuse by male shamans, where the most commonplace abuses have occurred, we also acknowledge that abuse happens by and toward other genders. This guide embraces a culturally-sensitive approach toward raising awareness and the avoidance of abuse in typical scenarios without diminishing the fact that abuse is unlawful and unacceptable in all circumstances.

Why Does Sexual Assault Occur in Ayahuasca Healing Contexts?

Sexual assault in ayahuasca settings involves a wide spectrum of abuse, including invasive touching, “consensual” sex between healer and participant, and rape. The abuse of participants by healers and facilitators in ayahuasca ceremonial contexts, like any sexual assault, is an abuse of power. It is a gross perversion of the healer-participant dynamic, in which the healer or facilitator uses their position of power and responsibility to gratify personal sexual and power interests. This is especially harmful and shocking considering many women who drink ayahuasca are seeking healing for sexual traumas suffered in the past. Sexual relations between healer and patient or religious leader and follower are an obvious violation of healer-patient and religious codes of conduct. The globalization of ayahuasca presents complex cross-cultural interactions where local and global moral codes and gender relational norms often come into contact and conflict, further complicating healer-patient and religious leader-follower relations. Many Western people now partake of ayahuasca ceremonies in South American contexts where mutual misconceptions of the “other” are commonplace. For instance, “shamans” are often highly romanticized in the Western imagination as being perfect beings or god-like. Some South American, and indeed Western, men have learned to take advantage of some of these exalted images of healers. Equally unjustly, local men may view Western women as sexually promiscuous. Economic inequalities and incentives further complicate these cross-cultural interactions whereby local healers may attempt to improve their financial prospects and social standing through entering into relations with Western women. This is especially prevalent in the current context of the commercialization of ayahuasca. Yet, these cross-cultural considerations cannot fully explain sexual abuse in ayahuasca contexts, since South American women are also sexually abused by South American healers, and Western women by Western healers.

Sexual abuse between healer and patient is evident in spiritual and healing communities across cultures and throughout time. As in these wider contexts, many shamans or religious leaders claim to possess special powers that can heal others; some might promote “tantric” exercises and sexual contact that they claim can heal someone from past traumatic experiences.

They may argue that this will be a way to “regain the sacred energy of sex,” and that “society is moralistic and does not understand the freedom of sex,” etc., in order to gain sexual favors. Instances of so-called “consensual” sex between healer and patient and religious leader and follower often involve great power imbalances and intentional deception and manipulation on the part of the healer. The establishment of allegedly consensual relationships poses several challenges.

Chacruna recognizes that there are many healers, religious leaders, and facilitators working with ayahuasca with great integrity. Being aware of potentially relevant contexts in which misconduct has taken place allows us to make informed choices. All individuals have their own bodily autonomy and the right to make their own choices. All individuals have the right to say “no” to any situation they are not comfortable with, and the right to withdraw themselves from any situation that they are not comfortable in. Here, we offer for your consideration guidelines relevant to typical contexts of abuse. These guidelines were created through collaboration with women and men in the ayahuasca community across different cultural contexts, including indigenous as well as Western victims and survivors of abuse, and ayahuasca healers and ceremonial facilitators. Researchers and regional experts have also been consulted. Please note that this guide is trying to cover indigenous, mestizo, religious, therapeutic, neoshamanic and New Age circles, so not all items are applicable to all contexts. Please use your best judgement.

Safety Guidelines

1. Consider Drinking with Friends. Partaking in ayahuasca in ceremonies or any healing practice alone with the healer has been a common context in which sexual abuse has occurred. We advise that you consider being accompanied by a trusted companion.

2. Consider Drinking with Experienced Women or Couples. As an extra precaution, one may wish to ensure there are female healers or facilitators working in their chosen ceremonial setting. Many reputable places now ensure that experienced women are present to assist and safeguard female participants.

3. Check Out the Location and Healer. Check the reputation of any center, shaman or religious leader you plan to participate in a ceremony with through review sites, past participants, and other experienced people in the area. It is highly advised to consult women.

4. It is Not Necessary for Healers to Touch Intimate Parts of Your Body or any Area to which You Do Not Consent. Some healings are individually focused on the participant’s body, such as *sopladas* (when the shaman blows tobacco smoke over your body; typically head, chest, spine, hands, and feet) and *limpiezas* or *baños de plantas* (plant baths, whereby saturated plants are poured over you) but they do NOT entail touching your private parts. If a shaman, religious leader or facilitator does touch you in a way that makes you feel uncomfortable during a “healing,” it is your right to assert that you are not okay with this.

You can raise the issue on the spot, with trusted facilitators, organizers of the ceremony, or others outside the ceremonial setting.

5. Curaciones, Sopladas and Limpiezas Do Not Require You to Remove Your Clothes. It is certainly not necessary for you to be naked. It's true that in certain Colombian yage traditions, it is usual for participants to be asked to remove their shirt for a limpieza, but it is normal for bras or camisoles to be kept on. This is also true for plant baths, for which you can wear swimwear, underwear, or whatever you feel comfortable with. A healer may offer to do a "special" or individual healing outside of the ceremony that can be very beneficial, but know that you are free to interrupt or decline any treatment. You may wish to ask another participant or a trusted companion to be with you during any such treatment. You have the right to be assertive about your personal needs to feel comfortable, regardless of any resistance from the healer.

6. Look out for Warning Signs that a Healer's Intentions with You Might Be Sexual. For example: if he is complimentary of your looks, he is overly "touchy" with you, he tells you his wife doesn't mind him having sex with other women, he encourages pacts of silence and secrecy between you, he says he wants to teach you love magic, he states that ayahuasca can enhance sexual activity, or he declares that you are special and chosen and offers you ceremonial and religious status. Beware that these kinds of comments and actions have shown that a healer is likely trying to seduce you.

7. Sexual Intercourse Between Healer and Patient During Ceremonies or directly after the Ceremonies is Not Acceptable in Ayahuasca Traditions. If a ceremonial leader wants to have sex with you during or soon after the ceremony, he is committing a transgression. This is considered inappropriate and spiritually dangerous in all traditions.

8. Sexual Intercourse with a Healer Does Not Give You Special Power and Energy. This is a relatively common argument made by men who want to have sex with their ceremonial participants; it can also be a major motivation for why women sometimes flirt, reciprocate flirtations or willingly engage in sexual relations with healers. While no participant can be told what they can and cannot do with their bodily autonomy, sleeping with a shaman will not make you a shaman, neither will it heal you from your past sexual trauma.

9. Consider Cultural Differences and Local Behavioral Norms when Interacting with Native Healers. There are some rather benign interactions in Western culture that carry different meanings elsewhere, and can potentially be culturally inappropriate and misunderstood. Overt or internalized misogynistic tendencies that view women as being passive—meaning that men merely need to be verbally or physically suggestive with women for sex to take place—are a widespread problem in South America and elsewhere.

It may be helpful to consider cultural differences when interacting with healers and their community, as certain behaviors, such as being alone with men, being complimentary, prolonged eye contact or “free spirited” behavior, like bathing naked in public spaces, can be misconstrued as gestures of sexual interest. We are not stating that misinterpretation of cross-cultural codes is justified, only that individuals can benefit from being aware of such potential misinterpretations.

10. Consider Cultural Differences and Local Clothing Customs. Non-local women are often viewed as being desirable, exotic, and sexually promiscuous across cultures. Without condoning these misconceptions and their underlying assumptions, it may be helpful, for your own protection, to consider local clothing customs when attending ceremonies and traveling around in foreign countries. Indeed, the request to not wear revealing clothing is common for many spiritual, meditation, and other healing retreats.

11. Protect Your Personal Space. Physically and Spiritually: Before, During, and After Ceremony. Healers with integrity will respect your right to do this. You should not feel obliged to engage in verbal or physical communication with healers, facilitators or anyone else during or following ceremony.

12. Be Wary of Healers Who Offer Psychoactive Substances Other Than Those Used During Ceremonies. The use of additional psychoactive substances within and outside of ceremonies, besides medicinal plants used in the ayahuasca brew and for shamanic dietas, is sometimes associated with scenarios of abuse. These substances may be presented as “medicines” or therapeutic treatments involving the healing of energy imbalances, or “sexual chakra releases.”

13. He’s a Shaman, Not a Saint! Remember, shamans and other ceremonial or religious leaders are men (and women) with human flaws, sexual urges, and the potential to abuse their power and cause harm. They do not necessarily live according to the moral standards one might expect of a spiritual leader. Imagining certain individuals to have superhuman qualities is likely an erroneous and dangerous misconception.

14. If a Violation Occurs, Get Support. Don’t suffer in silence. It’s not your fault if you experience abuse. Ideally, speak out on the spot or let someone in a leadership position within the ceremony circle itself know. If you are able to report the abuse immediately, it can send a strong message that this will not be tolerated and potentially protect other women from harm. However, you may not feel safe to do this or, you may not fully realize abuse has occurred until after the fact. It is very common for women who have been previously traumatized to experience a “freeze” response during a violation or uncomfortable situation. You have the right to report this abuse afterward, even if you were unable to address it at the time. Seek outside support and, if necessary, legal advice. Different countries have different legislations; try to get informed about your rights and where an incident can be reported.

15. Beware of what Might Appear to be Consensual Sex. Consent should happen in a mutually intelligible language where “consent” means the same things to all individuals involved. If you are considering having a sexual encounter with a shaman or facilitator, bear in mind that consensual sex may still involve an imbalance and abuse of power. It is also possible, according to some shamanic practices, for ceremonial leaders to intentionally influence participants into feeling attraction towards them, through love magic and other techniques. Allow time for integration and for the effects of ayahuasca and its often-ensuing sense of empowerment or euphoria to wear off so that you can apply clear judgement.

16. Beware of Getting Romantically Involved. Feeling attraction toward the ayahuasquero or a fellow participant can happen. As part of their ceremonial experience, some women have dreams and visions about the shaman or other fellow participants, and can get sexually aroused before, during, and after ceremonies. Such feelings are normal and one should not be ashamed of them.

17. If You are Aware of or Witness Sexual Abuse, Speak Up! We are all responsible for combating sexual abuse in our communities. Collaborative efforts are essential to denouncing perpetrators and eradicating sexual abuse in ayahuasca circles.

Resources

Fernandez, A. C. (2018). Sexual abuse in the contexts of ritual use of ayahuasca. www.chacruna.net. Retrieved from <https://chacruna.net/sexual-abuse-contexts-ritual-use-ayahuasca/>. This text is an adaptation of the original: Fedrnandez, A. C. (2018). Power and legitimacy in the reconfiguration of the yagecero field in Colombia. In B. C. Labate & C. Cavnar (Eds.), The expanding world ayahuasca diaspora: Appropriation, integration and legislation (pp. 199–216). New York City, NY: Routledge. You can download the article here: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/326876956_Power_and_legitimacy_in_the_reconfiguration_of_the_yagecero_field_in_Colombia

Peluso, D. (2018, October 5). Ayahuasca’s attractions and distractions: Examining sexual seduction in shaman-participant interactions, www.chacruna.net <https://chacruna.net/sexual-seduction-ayahuasca-shaman-participants-interactions/>. This text is an adaptation of the original, Peluso, D. (2014) Ayahuasca’s attractions and distractions: Examining sexual seduction in shaman-participant interactions, in B. C. Labate & C. Cavnar (Eds.), Ayahuasca shamanism in the Amazon and beyond. New York City, NY: Oxford University Press. You can download the article here: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/290436641_Ayahuasca%27s_attractions_and_distractions_examining_sexual_seduction_in_shaman-participant_interactions

To download this publication in additional languages see:

<https://chacruna.net/community/ayahuasca-community-guide-for-the-awareness-of-sexual-abuse/>